TRANSFORMING INDIA'S MARITIME LANDSCAPE



A VISIONARY JOURNEY TOWARDS DEEP DRAFT MEGA PORTS CATALYSED THROUGH SAGARMALA

"From historic trade hubs like Lothal to the modern-day maritime landscape, our ports have played a pivotal role in economic development. Under the visionary leadership of Hon'ble PM Modi, India's maritime sector has witnessed a renaissance, with our ports now leading in global competitiveness. Ministry of Ports, Shipping, and Waterways, has tirelessly worked on transforming the maritime sector since 2014, with significant progress achieved through programs like the Sagarmala initiative. To realise the goal of 'Vikasit Bharat,' we are working on a mission mode under Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047 to develop world class deep draft Mega Ports with cutting-edge smart technology and Green Hydrogen Hubs."

Sh. Sarbananda Sonowal
Hon'ble Union Minister
Ports, Shipping and Waterways and AYUSH

For centuries, India's ports have been vital hubs of global trade and diplomacy, serving as gateways to the rest of the world. From the ancient sea routes of the Silk Road and Spice Route to modern-day shipping lanes, India's ports have played a crucial role in connecting the country to other nations and cultures. The port cities of ancient India, such as **Lothal, Dholavira,** and **Muziris**, were once bustling centres of international trade, with merchants from as far away as Rome exchanging goods and ideas. Under the visionary leadership of **Hon'ble Prime Minister Narendra Modi,** India's ports are at the forefront of the country's economic growth, propelling the nation towards a more prosperous future. India's trade contributes 30% to country's GDP and **over 90% of this trade volume** is borne by Indian Ports. As India sets target of becoming USD 32 trillion economy by 2047, its ports will have major contribution as logistics centres of India's trade economy. The Ministry of Ports, Shipping, and Waterways, led by Sh. Sarbananda Sonowal has been instrumental in driving transformative changes in the maritime sector and catapulting the country into a new era of maritime prowess.

Revitalizing the Maritime Sector

One of the most notable milestones in this regard is the doubling of overall port cargo handling capacity to more than **2,500 million tonnes per annum**, a feat that has significantly bolstered India's ability to handle increased maritime traffic. This expansion has not only addressed the growing demands of trade and commerce but has also positioned India as a formidable player on the global maritime stage. Furthermore, a key indicator of the sector's enhanced efficiency is the remarkable reduction in Container **Vessel Turnaround Time (TAT),** a critical metric for port performance. This time has been slashed from an average of 4 days to an impressive **0.9 days**, ahead of many advanced nations e.g. Malaysia, New Zealand, Germany, etc., signalling a dramatic improvement in the speed and agility with which containers are processed through Indian ports.

The global recognition of Indian ports has soared, with two key ports, Mundra and Jawaharlal Nehru Port, securing positions among the **Global Top 30 Ports**. This achievement represents a monumental shift, considering the absence of any Indian ports in the top 30 before 2014.